



LISTENING & STUDY SKILLS

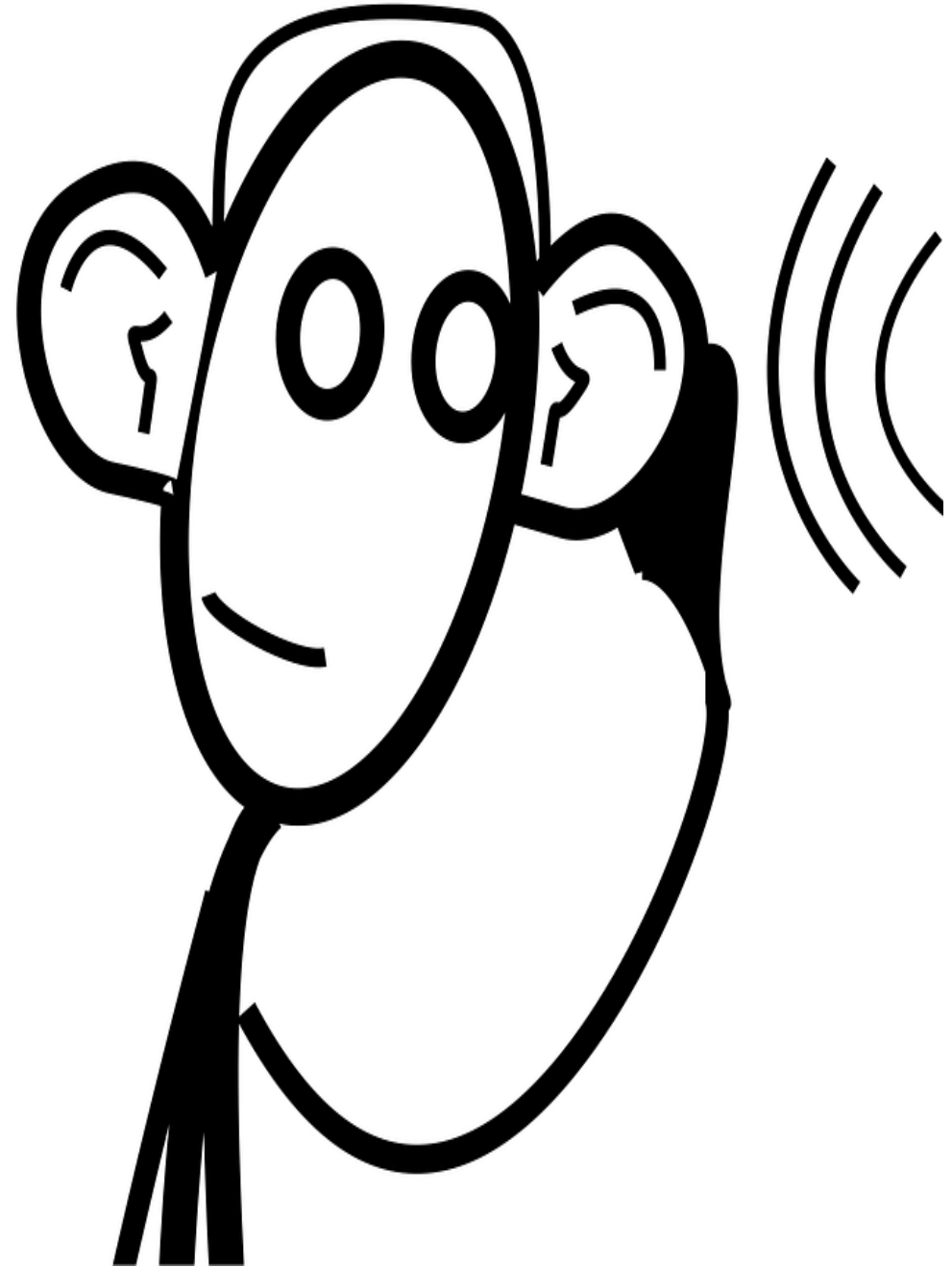
Lecture 7

LISTENING SKILLS

"We were given two ears but only one mouth, because listening is twice as hard as talking."

Listeners must first **hear** what is said. Listening skills involve identifying and selecting relevant points recognized as having **meaning**; that are **understood** and held in short-term memory.

These can be related to what has gone before and to what comes after. Any information considered important is selected and stored for future reference in the **long-term** memory



Effective LISTENING SKILLS

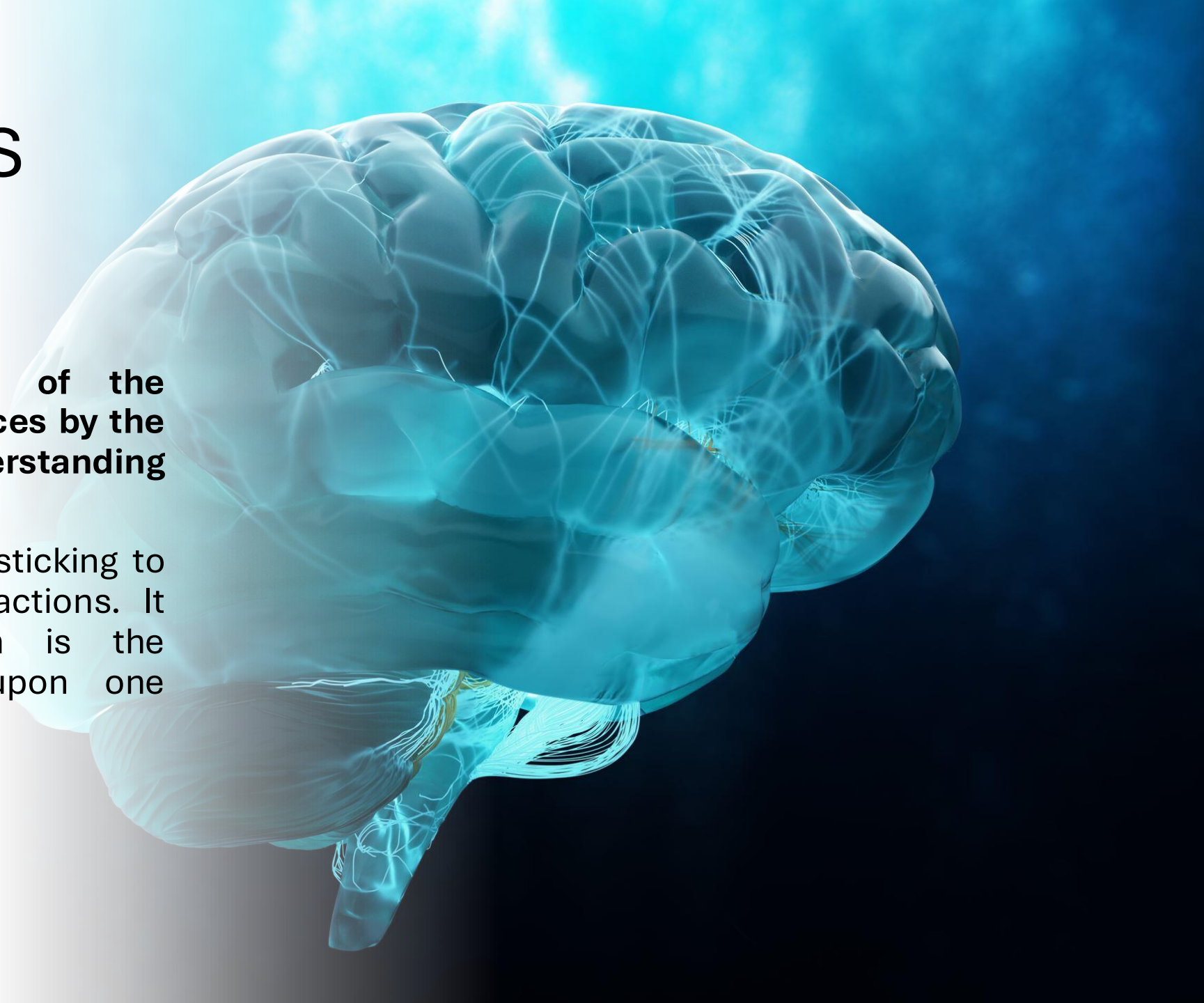
Decoding (understanding) a message is generally easier for the listener if a person is **speaking** rather than reading something out loud. In addition the speaker's facial expressions, and the stress placed on words help the listener to **understand** the message. Developing **effective listening skills** involves two specific steps (Hartley & Bruckman, 2002). These are:

1. To develop the ability to recognize and deal with **barriers that prevents you listening** with full attention.
2. To develop and use behaviors which **help you to listen**. Such behaviors can also serve to let the other person know that you are giving them your full attention.

LISTENING SKILLS

Listening is the absorption of the meanings of words and sentences by the brain. Listening leads to the **understanding** of facts and ideas.

To listen is to **pay attention** or sticking to the task at hand despite distractions. It requires concentration, which is the focusing of your thoughts upon one problem.



Active listening



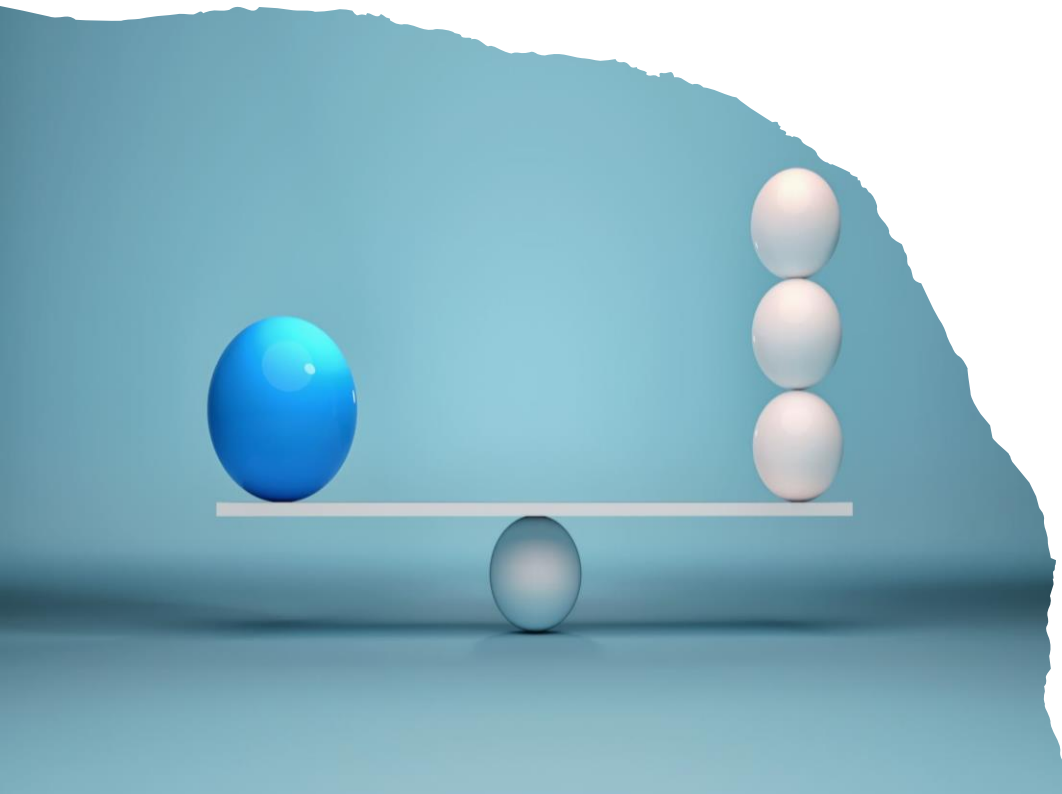
- Person who incorporates listening with concentration is actively listening. **Active listening** is a method of responding to another that encourages communication. Active listening is composed of six distinct components
- **Hearing:** The physiological process of receiving sound and/or other stimuli.
- **Attending:** The conscious and unconscious process of focusing attention on external stimuli.
- **Interpreting:** The process of **decoding** the symbols or behavior attended to.
- **Evaluating:** The process of deciding the value of the information to the receiver.
- **Remembering:** The process of placing the proper information into short-term or long-term storage.
- **Responding:** The process of giving **feedback** to the source and/or other receivers.

Barriers to Listening

- The following list shows just some barriers to effective listening:

1. sources of noise
2. Forming a judgment or evaluation before we understand what is being said, or „jumping to conclusions“.
3. Hearing what we want to hear.
4. Being inattentive - thinking about something else entirely.
5. Having a closed mind- you do not want to hear what the person has to say.
6. Feeling anxious or self-conscious.
7. Judging the person, either positively or negatively.
8. Cultural issues, e.g. listening to the differences in pronunciation of different accent, rather than the content of the message.

It is important that such barriers to listening are recognized and dealt with. With developing awareness, we can have more control over those barriers that are internal to ourselves and can adopt and use more helpful listening behaviors.



LISTENING EFFECTIVELY TIPS

Listening effectively is hearing and understanding what a speaker is saying and how it applies to you and then remembering it for future use and evaluation. There are ways to improve your listening skills for lectures. The following is a list of some basic techniques:

1. Recognize how ideas are organized. Lectures usually begin with some type of introduction, followed by a thesis statement which is supported by additional information. Most professors bring closure to their lecture by summarizing what they have covered. Learn to identify the lecture style that is used by your professor.

2. Become involved in what is being said. Be an avid listener. Constantly analyze what is being said.

3. Cut through (or screen out) distractions. • background noise • unusual accents, dialects, and language mistakes • speaker disorganization, emotion, or habits • unrelated material • your own inner voice

4. Organize statements into main points and supporting reasons. Using an outline form may be helpful.

5. Discriminate between relevancies and irrelevancies. Remember that not all information is important.

6. Maintain an active body state. Keeping alert and having eye-contact with the speaker will help you listen more effectively.

In order to improve your listening skills, you will need to practice using the suggested techniques until they become automatic

ACTIVITY 1

You will hear a girl talking about her brother, Toni.

Listen and complete questions 16–20.

You will hear the conversation twice.

Toni's had an accident.

He's hurt his:

leg

Name of hospital:

Room:

Floor:

Visiting hours:

4 p.m. to every day

Please take:



ACTIVITY 2

QUESTIONS 16–20

You will hear a man asking for some information about a language school.
Listen and complete questions 16–20.
You will hear the conversation twice.

School of Italian Studies

Length of courses: *6 or 9 months*

Next course begins on: **16**

Number of students in each class: **17**

Cost of coursebook: **18** £

School hours:

Monday to Friday: *From: 8 a.m. to: 7 p.m.*

Saturday: **19** *From: to:*

Nearest underground station: **20**



Study Skills

- To succeed in your studies at the college **you must study**. Studying is revising the notes you took during lectures and reading textbooks with the aim of understanding better what you are reading. For better understanding, it is important that you as a student come up with a study plan that works best for you.
- We are going to discuss some of the study plans and study tips that will help you to study better and gain good grades at the end of your undergraduate studies.



Study tips: Prepare a study timetable

- **1.** Draw up a **study timetable** and block in all activities, work, lectures, and any other responsibilities you may have. Include mealtimes and travel time.
- **Be realistic.** This should be an actual timetable, which is possible, not some ideal that can never be achieved. Make enough copies to cover all the weeks leading up to exams or assessment.
- **2.** Work out your most effective **study times**. When do you study best? Morning, afternoon, or evening? Early bird or night owl?
- **3. Consider:** Which subjects need **the most study** and revision? Estimate how many hours you think you need for each subject and try to match this with the hours available in your weekly planner.
- **4.** Block in some study times, preferably 2-4 hours at a time, with 5-10 minutes" break every 40-50 minutes.





Study tips: Prepare a study timetable

- **5. Start at exam periods** or due dates for assignments and work **backwards**, blocking in more study time in the relevant subject closer to the exam/due date. Make sure that you prepare for each exam over several days and don't fill up the last few days too heavily. Also **put in any events** which may affect your study times, such as birthdays, social events and work functions.
- **6.** You may want to plan in detail for each study session. Write down which lecture/topic/text you will be researching/ reviewing. This way, you can ensure that you will cover all the required information in the times you have allocated. Consider: **What do I want to achieve in this session?** (eg: summary/ notes / list of definitions/ language exercise/ essay plan/ list of resources/ timeline). Where will I need to study? Do I need access to a computer/ the internet/ the library?
- **7.** If you have some smaller amounts of time available for study, consider how they could be used: skim reading an article, proofing a draft, sorting a bibliography, organizing reference cards, etc. Travel time on public transport can also be used for reading.

Start using your study timetable.

- See how well it works. What did you leave out? It can be changed as you go, but do this consciously: look at what is not working, which areas you need more time in and change the timetable.
- This is much better than just throwing the timetable away. Then you can be sure that you will still cover all the material you need to.



Establish your Prime Study Time

- Your prime study time(PST) is that time when your concentration is at its highest. Everyone has a PST and they all know it. That is why some people wake up early in the morning to study(Such people their PST is early morning) while some stay up late to study. Study the subject you are having trouble with during your PST.
- Find a suitable room with comfortable furniture and good lighting.
- Set a regular time to study
- Remove distractions
- Avoid clutter (Clutter is anything that will distract you from reading what you had scheduled to read. Clutter includes books from other subjects, e.g. if you are studying Literature, then mathematics, Biology and other subject books are clutter because they can distract you from reading. Newspapers and story books are also clutter.)



- Record assignments in an assignment book or a Calander
- Take notes in class and review them regularly
- Study for tests

- **Make ONE minute act as TWO minutes:**

Anytime you have to wait for something read your short notes.
You will be able to kill two birds with one stone.

You will be able to do two things at the same time: wait as you read for example, When in the bus going to school, read your short notes. When you are in the restaurant waiting to be served, read your short notes.



TYPES OF STUDY PLANS

- It is important to note that there are other study plans that a student can use, but we are choosing to focus on these because we feel that they are the most applicable to our students. They can all be used simultaneously by one student.

1. Preview

Preview is reading about the topic you are going to be lectured on before the lecture. You are often given a course outline beforehand so that it can help you in previewing. Preview gives you an upper hand because you will be able to follow and understand what the lecturer is talking about. It enhances your chances of retaining what is taught.

Remember knowledge starts from known to unknown. You can also preview notes from the previous lecture so that you can understand the link between the previous lecture and the current lecture.

2. Studying with Breaks



Studying with Breaks also called **spaced study** is a very good technique for studying. It involves studying for a period then taking a short break followed by another study session.



For example, you can study for 2 hours then take a 10minute break followed by another 1 hour of study. Spaced study is good because if used well the student will be able to lock what they are studying in their long-term memory (LTM) during the breaks.



The breaks act as a **reward**. Humans thrive when they are rewarded. Your mind will also appreciate the reward. During the breaks reflect on what you have studied. Do not use the breaks negatively.



3- Group Study

Studying with a group of your friends can be both a fun and rewarding study method. For effective studying, it is important that you choose your group members wisely and follow a few rules. Study groups should:

1

Not be the sole method of study and they are not for everyone

2

Be a form of 'active learning' - the strongest kind of learning

3

Not let one member of the group dominate

4

Meet no more than 2-3 times a week

5

Establish responsibilities for each group member

6

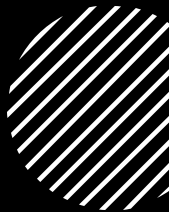
Design rules dealing with respect for each member

7

Provide contact information for group members



Importance of study groups



Help you and your group members:



See the material from a different perspective



Stay motivated and commit more time to study



Share/compare notes and study tips



Engage in discussions and debates on selected topics



Pick up new tips and material from your peers



Quiz each other on factual material